

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

In Backtalk we speak with Sachin Kalantri of Qualcomm to get their views on the emerging landscape of mobile tech. We also take a tour of the Oppo factory, for an in-depth look at how they manufacture phones. In Backbyte, enjoy our month in memes.

Source: iFixit



Google x iFixit Genuine Pixel Parts Program

In a move that brought smiles to the faces of many Pixel users worldwide, Google announced their Genuine Pixel Parts Program, in collaboration with iFixit. <https://dgit.in/ifixgoog>

WHAT'S NEW

USB-C FTW in the EU!

In September last year, the European Commission put forward legislation calling for the industry-wide adoption of USB-C ports in electronic devices and other unified charging solutions. Now, in the latest developments surrounding this move, the Members of the European Parliament have voted in an overwhelming majority to take this forward.

As per the initial proposal, four standardized guidelines were to be implemented. The first was USB-C port in electronic devices. The second was for a more harmonized fast charging technology, ensuring that the manu-



facturers would not be able to 'unjustifiably limit the charging speed' of devices. The third was allowing the consumers to buy electronics without

a charger. Lastly, appropriate information would have to be provided about the charging performance of the devices.

As far as the next steps regarding this are concerned, the legislation would go into its final stage, where the EU governments would decide on its final form. <https://dgit.in/EUsbC>

Meta to open retail stores

Meta, the organization that seems to be leading the charge for the move into the metaverse, has taken the call to open a physical retail store in Burlingame, California. This store, which is all set to open on the 9th of May, would serve as a place where the visiting consumers would be able to get hands on user experience of an innovative line of technological products, which include the Meta Portal, Ray-Ban Stories and Meta Quest 2.

To ensure that the hardware that Meta is behind can be bought easily by the con-



Source: Meta website

sumers who are already in a virtual world of their choosing while resting in their couches, the company has also opened

a web store. This comes in the form of an additional page on meta.com, where all the products are listed.

The Head of Meta Store, Martin Gilliard was quoted talking about this new venture on the Meta website. She said, "Once people experience the technology themselves, they can gain a better appreciation for it. If we did our job right, people should leave and tell their friends, 'You've got to go check out the Meta Store.'" <https://dgit.in/metaretail>



Source: Tesla

No included mobile connector

Some disappointing news for prospective Tesla drivers, the company recently announced that the Mobile connector, which used to be an included standard accessory with Tesla vehicles, will now be sold separately on their website. <https://dgit.in/nomc>



Source: HM Treasury via Twitter

A Royal NFT

UK Chancellor Rishi Sunak has called for the minting of an NFT by The Royal Mint of the UK, with the release time set for the coming summers. The move would show that UK is seemingly taking a forward-looking approach with cryptoassets. There will apparently be a gap of four months between NFTs. <https://dgit.in/royalnft>



Source: Apple

Apple self-repair!

Apple earlier this month, announced the official start of its Apple's Self Service Repair service. This would allow willing customers to pick and buy from 200 individual parts and tools, which will be made available to them in order to repair their devices. <https://dgit.in/appleselfrep>